



BEFORE

Prewar partisanship carried over into the war years, especially in the North. Republicans were much more likely to support the Lincoln administration's war measures than Democrats.

PARTY LINES

Both parties were in turn divided into factions that waxed and waned as wartime events inspired or deflated political aspirations. The Northern Democrats were divided between **War Democrats**, who generally supported the war against the Confederacy, and the **Peace Democrats, also known as Copperheads**, who steadfastly resisted Republican war measures to the point of being declared traitorous. The **Republicans had "radicals" and "moderates,"** who frequently disagreed about how best to reconstruct occupied areas of the South, deal with the freedmen, and treat captured enemies. Prewar political affiliations thus dictated home-front support of the war, especially at the local level.

In the South, the demands of war exacerbated prewar class differences. It was in areas of the Confederacy where stratification among whites was most evident, such as in upcountry Alabama and western Virginia, that support for the war effort was most divided. Initially, nearly all classes were enthusiastic about fighting for independence, but as the Union army advanced deeper into the South and Confederate war measures became more demanding, prewar class distinctions became harmful to Southern national unity. The draft and tax-in-kind—tax paid in the form of goods, crops, or even impressed enslaved people taken into Confederate service—both struck the lower and middle classes the worst, leading to cries among yeoman and hardscrabble farmers that this was a “rich man’s war and a poor man’s fight.”

Northern growth

Because of sound financial policies shepherded by Secretary of the Treasury Salmon P. Chase and his Wall Street mogul Jay Cooke, the Union’s economic health began in critical condition and ended in robust prosperity. In 1862, the treasury was empty, and a solution had to be found—fast. Chase hired Cooke to market Federal war bonds, which were eagerly scooped up by investors. This was followed by the introduction of “greenbacks” (Federally issued paper money backed by gold), so pressure on the Northern economy lessened. Import duties, the traditional source of Federal income,